

WEBRUM-04: Session Analysis

Series: WEBRUM — Web Real User Monitoring | **Notebook:** 4 of 8 | **Created:** March 2026 | **Last Updated:** 04/04/2026

Overview

User session analysis is the foundation of understanding how real users interact with your web applications. A session represents a complete visit — from the first page load to the last interaction before timeout. By analyzing sessions, you can identify user journey patterns, measure engagement, track conversions, calculate bounce rates, and understand how geographic location and device type impact the user experience.

This notebook covers session segmentation, user journey mapping, conversion funnel analysis, bounce rate calculations, and geographic/device breakdowns using DQL.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Dynatrace Environment	SaaS with Grail enabled
RUM Enabled	Web applications with session capture active
Session Properties	Custom session properties configured (optional but recommended)
Permissions	storage:events:read
Previous Notebook	WEBRUM-01: RUM Fundamentals

1. Session Properties

Dynatrace automatically captures standard session properties and allows you to define custom ones:

Standard Properties

Property	Description	Example Values
sessionId	Unique session identifier	abc123def456
userType	Session classification	REAL_USER , ROBOT , SYNTHETIC
application	Application name	MyWebApp
duration	Total session duration	300000000000 (nanoseconds)
userActionCount	Number of user actions	15
totalErrorCount	Number of errors in session	2
country	User's country	United States
city	User's city	Chicago
osFamily	Operating system	Windows , macOS , iOS

Property	Description	Example Values
<code>browserFamily</code>	Browser	Chrome , Firefox , Safari
<code>screen.width</code>	Screen width in pixels	1920
<code>screen.height</code>	Screen height in pixels	1080
<code>connection.type</code>	Network connection type	4g , wifi , ethernet

Custom Session Properties

Define custom properties via **Settings > Web and mobile monitoring > Session and user action properties**. Common examples:

- `session.user_id` — Authenticated user identifier
- `session.plan_type` — Subscription tier (free, pro, enterprise)
- `session.cart_value` — Shopping cart total
- `session.ab_variant` — A/B test variant

```
// Explore session data – view available fields
fetch user.sessions, from:-1h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| limit 5
```

2. Session Segmentation

Segmenting sessions helps identify patterns across different user groups. Common segmentation dimensions include engagement level, error impact, and return frequency.

```
// Engagement segmentation – bucket sessions by number of actions
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| fieldsAdd engagement = if(userActionCount == 1, "Bounce",
  else: if(userActionCount <= 3, "Low (2-3 actions)",
  else: if(userActionCount <= 10, "Medium (4-10 actions)",
  else: "High (10+ actions)"))
| summarize session_count = count(),
  avg_duration = avg(duration),
  avg_errors = avg(totalErrorCount),
  by:{engagement}
| sort session_count desc
```

```
// Error-impacted sessions – how many sessions had errors?
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| summarize total_sessions = count(),
  error_sessions = countIf(totalErrorCount > 0),
  by:{application}
| fieldsAdd error_session_pct = round(toDouble(error_sessions) /
toDouble(total_sessions) * 100.0, decimals: 1)
| sort error_session_pct desc
```

3. User Journey Mapping

Understanding the sequence of actions within sessions reveals common navigation paths, dead ends, and drop-off points.

```
// Top entry pages – where do users start their journey?
fetch user.events, from:-24h
| filter action.type == "Load"
| summarize first_action = takeFirst(action.name), by:{sessionId}
| summarize entry_count = count(), by:{first_action}
| sort entry_count desc
| limit 10
```

```
// Top exit pages – where do users leave?
fetch user.events, from:-24h
| filter action.type == "Load"
| summarize last_action = takeLast(action.name), by:{sessionId}
| summarize exit_count = count(), by:{last_action}
| sort exit_count desc
| limit 10
```

```
// Session duration distribution by hour of day – when are users most active?
fetch user.sessions, from:-7d
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| fieldsAdd hour = getHour(timestamp)
| summarize session_count = count(),
    avg_duration_sec = avg(toDouble(duration) / 1000000000.0),
    by:{hour}
| sort hour asc
```

4. Conversion Tracking

Conversion tracking identifies which sessions completed a desired business action (purchase, signup, form submission). This requires either:

- **Session properties** marking conversion events
- **Specific user actions** that indicate conversion (e.g., a "Thank You" page load)

Conversion via Action Name Detection

If your conversion page has a recognizable URL pattern, you can detect conversions from user actions:

```
// Conversion rate – sessions that reached a checkout/confirmation page
// Adapt the action.name filter to match your conversion page
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| summarize total_sessions = count(),
  by:{application}
| append [
  fetch user.events, from:-24h
  | filter action.type == "Load"
  | filter action.name ~ "*confirmation*" or action.name ~ "*thank*you*" or
action.name ~ "*checkout*success*"
  | summarize converted_sessions = countDistinct(sessionId), by:
{application}
]
```

Tip: For accurate conversion tracking, use Dynatrace session properties to flag conversion events. This avoids reliance on URL pattern matching, which can be fragile.

5. Bounce Rate Analysis

A "bounce" is a session with only one user action — the user loaded one page and left. High bounce rates may indicate poor landing page relevance, slow performance, or broken functionality.

```
// Bounce rate by application
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| summarize total_sessions = count(),
  bounced_sessions = countIf(userActionCount == 1),
  by:{application}
| fieldsAdd bounce_rate_pct = round(toDouble(bounced_sessions) /
toDouble(total_sessions) * 100.0, decimals: 1)
| sort bounce_rate_pct desc
```

```
// Bounce rate trend over 7 days – track improvement over time
fetch user.sessions, from:-7d
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| fieldsAdd is_bounce = if(userActionCount == 1, 1, else: 0)
| makeTimeseries total = count(), bounces = sum(is_bounce), interval:1d
| fieldsAdd bounce_rate = arrayAvg(bounces) / arrayAvg(total) * 100.0
```

6. Geographic Analysis

RUM data includes geographic information derived from the user's IP address. This helps identify regional performance differences and target optimization efforts.

```
// Sessions by country – top 15 countries by volume
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| filter isNotNull(country)
| summarize session_count = count(),
    avg_actions = avg(userActionCount),
    avg_errors = avg(totalErrorCount),
    avg_duration_sec = avg(toDouble(duration) / 1000000000.0),
    by:{country}
| sort session_count desc
| limit 15
```

```
// Top 10 cities by session count with average performance
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| filter isNotNull(city) and isNotNull(country)
| summarize session_count = count(), by:{city, country}
| sort session_count desc
| limit 10
```

7. Device and Browser Analysis

Understanding the device and browser mix helps prioritize testing and optimization efforts.

```
// Session distribution by browser
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| filter isNotNull(browserFamily)
| summarize session_count = count(),
    avg_errors = avg(totalErrorCount),
    by:{browserFamily}
| sort session_count desc
| limit 10
```

```
// Session distribution by operating system
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| filter isNotNull(osFamily)
| summarize session_count = count(),
    avg_duration_sec = avg(toDouble(duration) / 1000000000.0),
    by:{osFamily}
| sort session_count desc
```

```
// Screen resolution distribution – identify common viewport sizes
fetch user.sessions, from:-24h
| filter userType == "REAL_USER"
| filter isNotNull(screen.width) and isNotNull(screen.height)
| fieldsAdd resolution = concat(toString(screen.width), "x",
    toString(screen.height))
| summarize session_count = count(), by:{resolution}
| sort session_count desc
| limit 10
```

8. Summary and Next Steps

In this notebook, we covered:

- **Session properties** — Standard and custom properties for segmentation
- **Engagement segmentation** — Bucketing sessions by interaction depth
- **User journey mapping** — Entry/exit pages and activity by time of day
- **Conversion tracking** — Identifying sessions that completed business goals
- **Bounce rate analysis** — Measuring and trending single-action sessions
- **Geographic analysis** — Session distribution by country and city
- **Device/browser analysis** — Understanding the technology mix of your users

Next Steps

- **WEBRUM-05: Error Analysis** — JavaScript error tracking and impact analysis
- **WEBRUM-06: Performance Analysis** — Deep dive into page load waterfall timings

References

- [Session Properties](#)
- [User Session Query](#)

This notebook was AI-generated from community-submitted and publicly available sources. This notebook series is not officially supported by Dynatrace. Always verify information against official Dynatrace documentation.